

5 Google Ads mistakes killing your e-commerce budget

Most brands make these before writing a single ad.

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1

Skipping conversion tracking setup

Running Google Ads without verified conversion tracking is like driving blindfolded — you are spending money with zero proof of what is working. Most Indian e-commerce brands launch campaigns before confirming that purchase events are actually firing correctly in Google Tag Manager.

2

Choosing broad match from day one

Broad match without a strong negative keyword list will burn your budget on completely irrelevant searches within 48 hours. Start with exact or phrase match, build your search term report for at least two weeks, then expand deliberately.

3

Setting daily budgets too thin to learn

Google's algorithm needs roughly 50 conversions per month per campaign to exit the learning phase properly. If your daily budget is ■200 on a ■800 average order value product, the campaign will never stabilise and your CPA data will be meaningless.

4

Ignoring search term reports entirely

The search terms report shows exactly what real users typed before clicking your ad — it is the most honest feedback your campaign gives you.

Reviewing it weekly and adding irrelevant terms as negatives can reduce wasted spend by 20 to 35 percent within a month.

5

Sending all traffic to the homepage

Sending a user who searched for 'men's running shoes under 2000' to your homepage forces them to do the work your landing page should do.

Product-specific or collection-specific landing pages consistently outperform homepage traffic in both conversion rate and Quality Score.

Letting Google auto-apply recommendations

Google's auto-apply recommendations are designed to increase spend, not necessarily your profitability. Automatically adding broad match keywords or raising budgets without your input can destabilise a campaign that was just beginning to perform.

Launching Shopping ads without feed hygiene

A product feed with missing GTINs, vague titles, or incorrect categories will get your Shopping ads shown to the wrong audience or disapproved outright. Auditing your Merchant Center for errors before launch is not optional — it directly determines your impression share.

**Fix these first. Your ads
will thank you.**

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